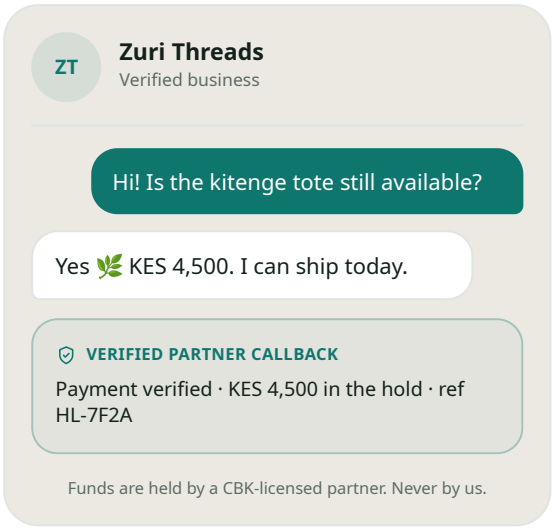
ESCROW + DELIVERY FOR SOCIAL COMMERCE

Trust, built into the chat.

Buyers pay into a protected hold. Vendors ship with a tracking reference. Money moves only when the deal does.

- Funds sit with a CBK-licensed partner
- Delivery is proven, not assumed
- Humans decide money outcomes



Terms still open TBD

Escrow fee · TBD | Auto-release window · TBD | Payout holds · TBD

This prototype does not invent commercial terms. These stay as placeholders until they are set in the Terms.

“Money moves only when the deal does.”

Escrow, tracking and disputes — inside the same conversation.

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Three rules the product cannot break

Buyers pay into a protected hold. Vendors ship with a tracking reference. Money moves only when the deal does.

THE GAP

A buyer paying in a DM has no neutral proof that the money is protected. A vendor shipping on trust has no neutral proof that the parcel arrived.

THE ANSWER

A protected hold at a CBK-licensed partner, a mandatory tracking reference and a human-reviewed dispute path — inside the same conversation.

Funds sit with a CBK-licensed partner

We never hold buyer money. Release instructions come from the partner, on a verified callback.

Delivery is proven, not assumed

A tracking reference is mandatory before dispatch. The delivery path decides how strong the evidence is.

Humans decide money outcomes

AI can summarise and flag. It never releases funds, closes accounts or rules on a dispute.

How the money moves

01 Buyer pays

02 Partner holds funds

03 Vendor ships with tracking

04 Release or dispute

The platform is the product layer. The partner is the licensed holder.

Terms still open

Escrow fee · TBD

Auto-release window · TBD

Payout holds · TBD

This prototype does not invent commercial terms. These stay as placeholders until they are set in the Terms.

What this demo is not

- No backend, auth or database.
- No real payments or partner callbacks.
- No screenshots or SMS as proof of payment.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Money moves only when the deal does. The terms stay open until they are set.

Deal flow

One order, from hold to release. Every step is a typed transition with an actor and a precondition.

`CREATED` → `FUNDED` → `SHIPPED` → `IN_TRANSIT` → `DELIVERED` → `RELEASED`

`SHIPPED / IN_TRANSIT / DELIVERED` — OPEN_DISPUTE (buyer) → `DISPUTED`

DISPUTED — REVIEW_REFUND (reviewer) → REFUNDED · REVIEW_RELEASE (reviewer) → RELEASED

STATE	EVENT	TO	ACTOR	PRECONDITION
CREATED	FUND	FUNDED	Escrow partner	Verified partner callback confirms the hold
FUNDED	SHIP	SHIPPED	Vendor	Tracking reference recorded before dispatch
SHIPPED	IN_TRANSIT	IN_TRANSIT	Courier	Pickup or handover recorded
SHIPPED	OPEN_DISPUTE	DISPUTED	Buyer	Buyer reports an issue
IN_TRANSIT	DELIVER	DELIVERED	Courier	Delivery evidence attached
IN_TRANSIT	OPEN_DISPUTE	DISPUTED	Buyer	Buyer reports an issue
DELIVERED	BUYER_CONFIRM	RELEASED	Buyer	Buyer confirms receipt
DELIVERED	AUTO_RELEASE	RELEASED	System	Auto-release window elapsed (TBD — set in the Terms)
DELIVERED	OPEN_DISPUTE	DISPUTED	Buyer	Buyer reports an issue
DISPUTED	REVIEW_REFUND	REFUNDED	Human reviewer	Human reviewer upholds the dispute
DISPUTED	REVIEW_RELEASE	RELEASED	Human reviewer	Human reviewer dismisses the dispute

What the UI records

- **Audit log.** Every step names its actor — buyer, vendor, courier, partner, system or reviewer.
- **Evidence.** 4/4 items collected on the platform path at delivery; 2/4 with the vendor's own courier.
- **Ledger.** Hold and release rows are hash-chained; the fee line stays TBD.

Ledger snapshot

Chain verified

SEQ	ENTRY	KES	HASH
1	Hold	+4,500	5f76e9c5
2	Release	−4,500	e2c9e66a

Escrow fee: TBD — not posted until set in the Terms.

AUTO_RELEASE is shown but blocked. The window is TBD — set in the Terms, so the demo never invents a duration. Buyer confirmation remains the reachable release path on DELIVERED.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Every edge has an actor and a precondition. The interface cannot skip either.

Delivery paths

Two ways to move a parcel. Both require a tracking reference. Only the platform courier produces independent delivery evidence.

	Platform courier	Vendor's own courier
Who carries	Platform courier	Vendor's courier
Liability	Signed platform courier agreement	Signed liability agreement (vendor)
Tracking reference	Required before dispatch	Required before dispatch
Delivery proof	Pickup scan, signature, photo	Vendor delivery note + buyer confirmation
Release support	Independent courier events	Vendor records, backed by the agreement
Best for	Higher-value orders	Local, low-volume routes
Evidence strength	Strong · 4/4	Moderate · 2/4

Evidence strength · Platform courier

- ✓ Verified partner callback — Funds confirmed by the partner, not a screenshot
- ✓ Tracking reference — AMN-4K7Q recorded before dispatch
- ✓ Courier pickup scan — Platform courier event at handover
- ✓ Proof of delivery — Signature and photo attached

Evidence strength · Vendor's own courier

- ✓ Signed liability agreement — Vendor accepts liability for the parcel
- ✓ Tracking reference — AMN-4K7Q recorded before dispatch
- Vendor delivery note — Self-reported handover
- Independent delivery event — Not available without a platform courier

Why the agreement matters

With a vendor's own courier, the delivery record is self-reported. The signed liability agreement is what makes a release defensible, and it is why the evidence meter stops at moderate.

Tracking before dispatch
The SHIP edge has no path without a tracking reference.

Liability for own couriers
The same edge rejects an unsigned liability agreement.

Release stays human
A dispute blocks release until a reviewer decides.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Delivery proof is not payment proof — and a screenshot is neither.

Disputes

A dispute pauses the release. Funds stay in the hold until a human reviewer decides, using evidence both sides can see.

Uphold → refund

Buyer evidence is sufficient. The partner returns the held funds.

Dismiss → release

Delivery evidence is sufficient. The partner releases funds to the vendor.

Request more evidence

The reviewer asks both sides for specific records. The hold stays put.

What the reviewer sees

- Tracking events from the courier
- Delivery record and handover evidence
- Order details and the chat thread
- Item photos as evidence of condition — never as proof of payment

AI, advisory only

AI

AI may summarise the conversation and surface missing evidence. A person makes the call, and the ledger records who decided.

Review window: TBD — set in the Terms.

Mock case · torn strap

MOCK

A kitenge tote arrives with a torn strap. The buyer opens a dispute before confirming. The hold does not move.

01
Dispute opened

02
Evidence reviewed

03
Decision recorded

DECISION

Refund upheld by a human reviewer

AI NOTE — ADVISORY ONLY

Photos match the reported damage. Delivery scan is present. Recommendation for a human: refund.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A dispute pauses the money, not the conversation.

Trust & safety

The guarantees are structural, not promises in a support reply.

Funds with a CBK-licensed partner

The platform never touches buyer money. CBK is the Central Bank of Kenya.

Verified callbacks, not screenshots

Payment state changes only on a verified partner callback. Screenshots and SMS are never proof of payment.

Tracking before dispatch

A vendor cannot mark a parcel shipped without a tracking reference.

Human-reviewed disputes

Money outcomes are decided by a person, never by a model.

Append-only records

Audit entries and ledger rows are hash-chained and cannot be edited in place.

Minimum data

Phone number, order and delivery events. The demo stores no identity documents.

Hard limits for AI

- Cannot release or refund funds
- Cannot suspend or close an account
- Cannot decide a dispute
- Cannot mark a payment as received

AI may summarise, translate, flag missing evidence and route cases. Those are advisories, not decisions.

Enforcement, not policy copy

Tracking guard
SHIP is blocked when trackingRef is empty, for both paths.

Liability guard
Own courier also needs liabilitySigned before dispatch.

Auto-release guard
The window is TBD, so the edge stays closed in the demo.

CBK is the Central Bank of Kenya. In production, buyer funds would be held by a CBK-licensed partner — never by the platform. Payment state changes only on a verified partner callback; screenshots and SMS are never proof of payment.

KEY TAKEAWAY

These are control paths in code, not promises in a support reply.

Roadmap

Sequenced by dependency, not by date. Timelines are TBD.

01 TIMELINE: TBD

Now — prototype

- ✓ Typed deal state machine
- ✓ WhatsApp-style deal flow
- ✓ Audit log and hash-chained ledger
- ✓ English and Swahili UI

02 TIMELINE: TBD

Next — partner integration

- CBK partner sandbox callbacks
- Courier scan webhooks
- Reviewer console with evidence viewer
- Settlement and reconciliation

03 TIMELINE: TBD

Later — scale

- Multi-courier network
- Vendor risk scoring (advisory)
- Buyer protection education
- Swahili-first support

Run the interactive demo

```
npm install
npm run dev
# http://localhost:3000
```

English and Kiswahili, light and dark, keyboard navigation, and a URL hash for every section. Verified with 38 unit tests.

Built with

Next.js App Router + React 19

TypeScript strict + Tailwind CSS v4

Vitest: machine, ledger, content

No backend, auth, database or images

A showcase, not a product.

The escrow fee, auto-release window and payout holds remain TBD until set in the Terms. In production, funds would be held by a CBK-licensed partner, never by this platform.

github.com/AmanaLink/Demo

KEY TAKEAWAY

Sequenced by dependency, not by dates.